

Word family: **gear / gears / geared / gearing**

Base word: gear

Plural: gears

Past tense: geared

Past participle: geared

** -ing form:** gearing

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “He then showed me how to check the chain, clean the **gears**, and replace a worn-out part.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **gears** means the **toothed mechanical wheels in a bicycle that work together to transmit movement and change how hard or fast the bicycle is pedalled**.

繁體中文： **帶有齒牙、互相咬合並傳遞動力的機械零件；齒輪**

中文翻譯：

> “...check the chain, clean the **gears**...”

「.....檢查鏈條、清潔**齒輪**.....」

Here:

bicycle gears = 單車上用來傳遞動力並改變踩踏阻力 / 速度關係的齒輪系統

1. **gear = toothed mechanical wheel/system (機械) — 齒輪；齒輪系統**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A toothed wheel, or a set of such wheels, that transmits movement and force between moving parts.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He showed me how to clean the **gears**.”

「他教我如何清潔**齒輪**。」

Practice 2

> “One of the **gears** inside the machine was damaged.”

「機器裡其中一個**齒輪**損壞了。」

Practice 3

> “The bicycle has several **gears** for different slopes.”

「這輛單車有幾個不同的**檔位 / 齒輪設定**，可配合不同斜度。」

gear = 利用齒牙互相咬合、傳遞動力或改變速度 / 力量關係的機械部件或系統

2. **gear** = selected transmission setting (車輛 / 單車) — 檔位 ; 波檔

Gear can also mean one particular setting in a transmission system.

Practice 4

> “Change into a lower **gear** before climbing the hill.”

「上斜坡前要轉到較低的**檔位**。」

Practice 5

> “The car was still in first **gear**.”

「汽車仍然在—**檔**。」

gear = 車輛或單車傳動系統中的某一個速度 / 扭力設定

This is closely related to Meaning 1 but learner-wise useful to show separately because:

* **a gear** can mean the actual mechanical wheel;

* **first gear / low gear** means a transmission setting.

For strict counting, I would merge these under the broader **mechanical transmission** concept.

3. **gear** = equipment/clothing for a particular activity (裝備) — 裝備 ; 用具 ; 服裝

This is a major everyday meaning.

****Meaning:**** Equipment, clothing, or other items needed for a particular activity or purpose.

Practice 6

> “We packed all our camping ****gear****.”

「我們收拾好所有露營****裝備****。」

Practice 7

> “You need proper safety ****gear**** for this job.”

「做這份工作需要合適的安全****裝備****。」

****gear = 為某項活動、工作或用途而使用的一整套裝備、工具或服裝****

Common:

- * camping gear
- * sports gear
- * safety gear
- * climbing gear
- * fishing gear

This is genuinely distinct from mechanical gears.

4. ****gear = clothing, especially of a particular type (衣物) — 衣服 ; 服裝****

In informal English, ****gear**** can refer specifically to clothing.

Practice 8

> “He arrived wearing cycling ****gear****.”

「他穿着單車****裝備 / 服裝****到場。」

Practice 9

> “She changed into her running ****gear****.”

「她換上了跑步****裝備 / 運動服****。」

****gear = 為某種活動而穿着的服裝或相關裝備****

For core counting, I would merge this with Meaning 3.

The Manual tells us not to split purely because the object changes from tools to clothing when the broader “equipment for a purpose” concept still fits.

5. **gear** = belongings / stuff (非正式) — 東西 ; 物品

Informally, **gear** can mean a person's belongings or equipment in general.

Practice 10

> “Grab your **gear** and let’s go.”

「拿好你的**東西 / 裝備**，我們走吧。」

Practice 11

> “He left his **gear** by the door.”

「他把自己的**東西**放在門邊。」

gear = 某人隨身帶着或使用的一堆物品 / 裝備 ; 非正式

This is a broad extension of Meaning 3.

For strict counting, I would merge it under **equipment/belongings** rather than create a separate core meaning.

6. **gear** = illegal drugs (俚語) — 毒品

In some varieties of informal British English, **gear** can mean illegal drugs.

Practice 12

> “In some slang contexts, **gear** can refer to illegal drugs.”

「在某些俚語語境中，**gear** 可以指非法毒品。」

Practice 13

> “This use is highly informal and depends strongly on context.”

「這個用法非常口語化，而且高度依賴語境。」

****gear = 非法毒品；俚語，地域及語境限制較強****

This is a real modern slang sense, but lower-priority for a general learner database.

I would include it as a flagged informal extension rather than a central core meaning.

7. ****gear = make something suitable for a purpose (動詞) — 使配合；使適合****

As a verb, ****gear**** means to design or arrange something for a particular purpose, audience, or situation.

Practice 14

> “The course is ****geared**** toward beginners.”

「這個課程是****為初學者而設 / 配合初學者需要****的。」

Practice 15

> “The programme is ****geared**** to young children.”

「這個節目是****針對年幼兒童而設****的。」

****gear something to/toward someone/something = 使某事物配合特定目的、需要或對象****

This is a major figurative verb meaning.

8. ****gear = engage/change gears (機械動詞) — 入檔；換檔****

As a verb, ****gear**** can also relate directly to mechanical transmission.

Practice 16

> “The machine is ****geared**** for slower operation.”

「這部機器的齒輪設定為較慢速運作。」

Practice 17

> “The bicycle is ****geared**** for climbing.”

「這輛單車的傳動設定適合爬坡。」

****gear = 透過齒輪 / 傳動配置，使機械以某種速度、力量或用途運作****

For core counting, I would keep this under the mechanical branch.

Related form: ****geared****

****Geared**** has two useful branches.

**geared = mechanically configured (機械) — 齒輪配置為.....的**

Practice 18

> “The bike is ****geared**** for steep hills.”

「這輛單車的****齒輪配置****適合陡坡。」

**geared to/toward = designed for (針對) — 為.....而設**

Practice 19

> “The book is ****geared toward**** younger readers.”

「這本書是****針對年輕讀者而寫****的。」

This second branch is figurative and highly useful.

Related form: ****gearing****

****Gearing**** can mean the arrangement/system of gears.

Practice 20

> “The bicycle’s ****gearing**** makes hill climbing easier.”

「這輛單車的****齒輪傳動配置****令上斜坡更容易。」

****gearing = 齒輪的排列 / 傳動配置****

It also has specialized financial meanings, but those are sufficiently domain-specific that I would

not prioritize them in a general learner entry unless finance is being covered.

Important distinction: **gear vs equipment**

equipment

is the broad neutral word for tools/items needed for a task.

gear

is more informal and often refers to a set of equipment used for an activity.

> safety equipment

> safety gear

Both are natural.

But **gear** also has mechanical and transmission meanings that **equipment** does not.

Important distinction: **gear vs tool**

tool

= an individual implement used to do a task

gear

= usually a collection or set of equipment

> a screwdriver = a tool

> camping gear = all the equipment for camping

So **gear** is broader as a collective noun.

Important distinction: **gear vs cog**

gear

can mean a toothed wheel or the whole transmission setting/system.

****cog****

usually means one toothed wheel or one tooth-like component in a mechanism.

In everyday mechanical language:

> gear

is broader and much more common.

Important distinction: ****gear vs equipment vs belongings****

****gear****

can overlap with both.

* camping gear → equipment

* grab your gear → belongings/equipment

But ****belongings**** can include ordinary personal possessions that are not functional equipment.

Countability note

****Gear**** behaves differently by meaning.

Mechanical sense

Countable:

> a gear

> several gears

Equipment sense

Usually uncountable:

> camping gear 

> some gear 

Not normally:

> three gears

if you mean three sets of equipment.

This is an important learner distinction.

Useful expression: **change gear / change gears — 換檔**

Practice 21

> “Change **gear** before the hill.”

「上斜坡前先**換檔**。」

Practice 22

> “The driver changed **gears** smoothly.”

「司機很順暢地**換檔**。」

This belongs to the mechanical transmission sense.

Useful expression: **in gear / out of gear — 入檔 / 未入檔**

Practice 23

> “Make sure the car is in **gear**.”

「確保汽車已經**入檔**。」

Practice 24

> “The machine slipped out of **gear**.”

「機器的傳動裝置**脫離了齒輪咬合 / 脫檔**。」

Again, this belongs to the mechanical branch.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **gear**
* **gears**
* **geared**
* **gearing**

Useful constructions include:

* bicycle gears
* first gear
* low gear
* safety gear
* camping gear
* geared toward
* geared for
* change gear

The Golden Manual recommends covering common domain uses and grammatical patterns while merging those that still share one underlying semantic concept.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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gear — mechanical wheel/system	利用齒牙互相咬合、傳遞動力或改變速度 / 力量關係的齒輪或傳動系統
gear — transmission setting	車輛或單車傳動系統中的某一個速度 / 扭力設定；檔位
gear — equipment	為某項活動、工作或用途而使用的一整套裝備、工具或服裝
gear — belongings	某人使用或攜帶的一堆物品 / 裝備；與 equipment 義相關
gear — slang drugs	某些英式俚語中指非法毒品；低優先度
gear — verb, configure for purpose	使某事物配合特定目的、需要或對象
gearing	齒輪排列或傳動配置

For your original sentence

> “...check the chain, clean the **gears**, and replace a worn-out part.”

The exact meaning is:

****gears = 單車傳動系統中互相配合、改變踩踏阻力和速度關係的齒輪 / 檔位機構****

So:

> **clean the gears**

= **清潔單車齒輪 / 傳動齒輪組**

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely useful core meanings** for **gear**:

1. **mechanical gear / transmission setting**
2. **equipment, clothing, or belongings used for an activity**
3. **verb — design/configure something for a particular purpose or audience**

I would merge **first gear / bicycle gears / geared mechanically** into #1, merge **sports gear / safety gear / personal gear** into #2, and keep slang **gear = drugs** as a lower-priority flagged extension rather than part of the main core count.